



– LLM –

Hierarchical language models

INTRODUCTION



Goals :

- Improve the understanding of (very) long-term context
- Reason at different levels of abstraction.

Proposed solutions:

- XLNet (Yang et al.)
- Hierarchical Transformers (Pappagari et al.)
- Hierarchical Embeddings (ours)

Table of contents

1

Background

p. 5

2

Proposed architecture

p. 6

3

Results and possible
improvements

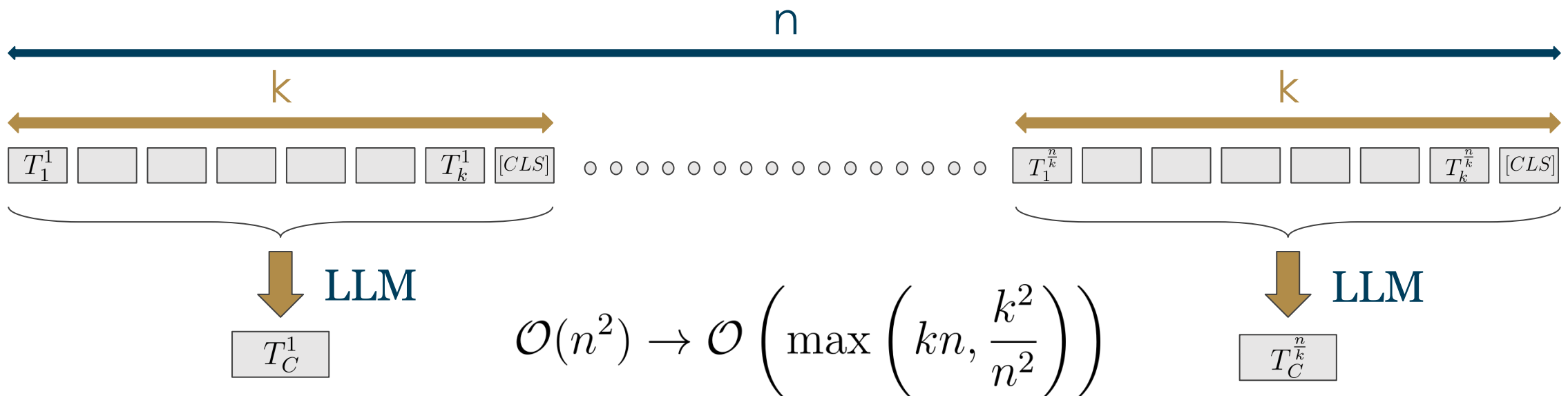
p. 14

1 - Background

Hierarchical Transformers (Pappagari et al., 2019)

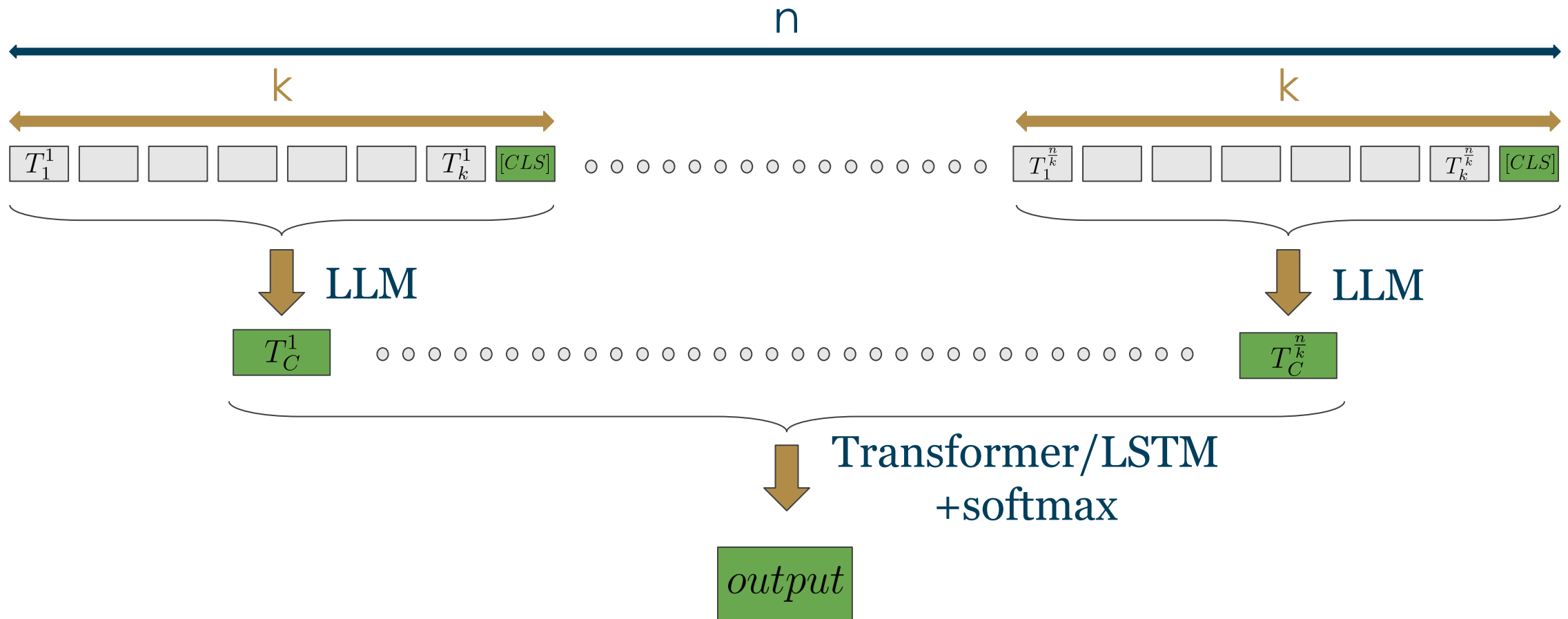
Text classification / Customer satisfaction prediction after a call

Improving the efficiency of text analysis



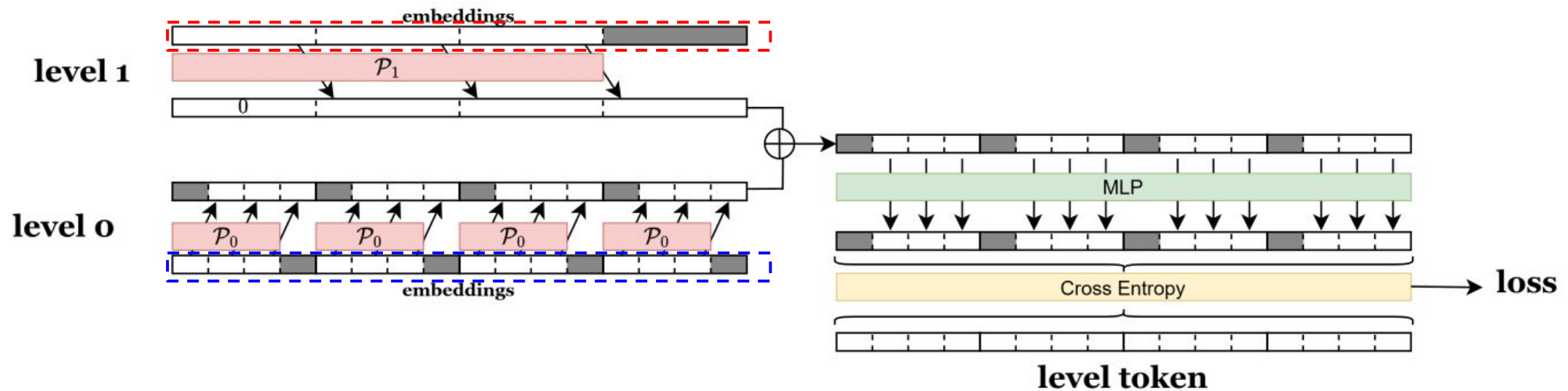
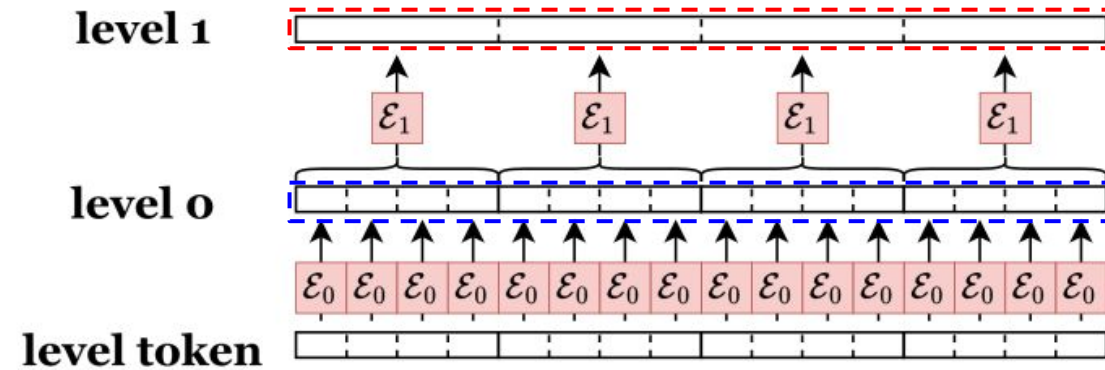
1 - Background

Hierarchical Transformers (Pappagari et al., 2019)

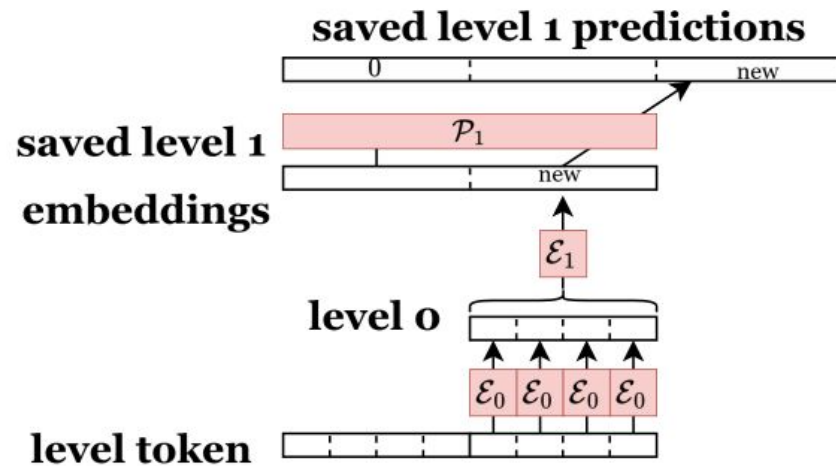


2 - Proposed architecture

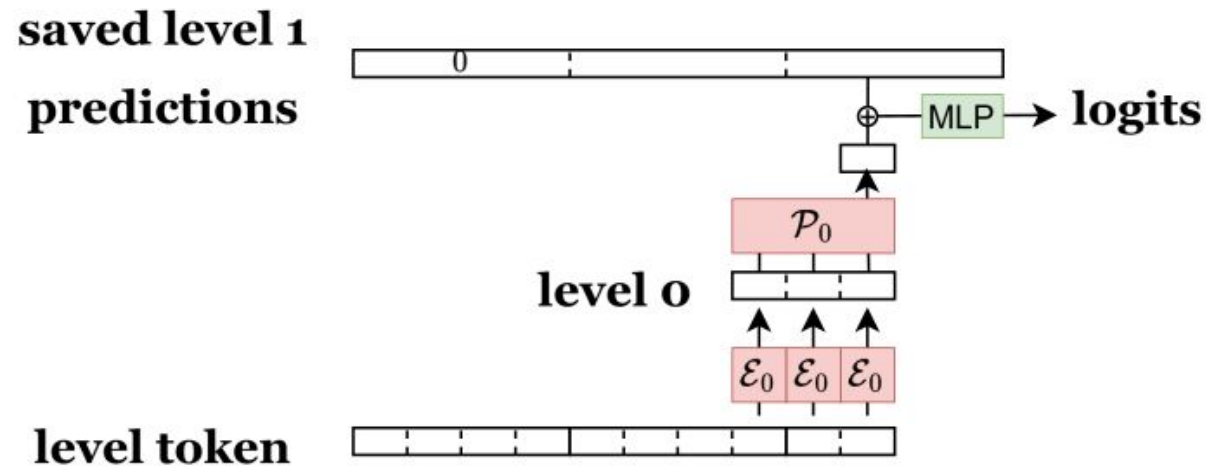
Training :



Inference :



Level 1 update



Token prediction

2 - Proposed architecture

$\mathcal{E}$ and $\mathcal{P}$ → **based on GPT2**

initial weights are kept

$\mathcal{E}_0$

Token embedder of
GPT2

$\mathcal{P}_0$

Transformers of
GPT2

$\mathcal{E}_1$

Transformers of GPT2 with
a CLS token

$\mathcal{P}_1$

Transformers of
GPT2

MLP = Last linear layer final of GPT2

→ **All of these networks are finetuned**

3 - Results and possible improvements

Training: batch_size=32 ; context_size_0 = 16 ; context_size_1 = 8

Validation: Loss identical to the training loss on a validation set (20 batches)

Method	Loss
No hierarchy	3.80
Inside sum	3.76
Outside sum	3.73
Outside sum and shared E1/Po	3.73

Results

Dataset used: state of the union

3 - Results and possible improvements



- **Embedding aggregation:** Concatenation or summation?
- **Result weighting:** Should the outputs of the different embeddings be weighted?
- **Respective embedding dimensions:** Should different dimensions be used for the latent spaces?
- **Loss:** Should an intermediate loss be added on the latent space?
- **Overlapping:** Should training use overlapping windows ?

CONCLUSION



- **Idea:** Separate prediction computations across multiple hierarchical levels → improved complexity and abstraction
- **Results:** Encouraging, but at a small scale → what would the outcome be on larger datasets? What about the quality of the embeddings?
- **Future directions:** Numerous possibilities for improvement and adaptation

Bibliography

- Pappagari, Raghavendra et al. (2019). *Hierarchical Transformers for Long Document Classification*. arXiv: [1910.10781](https://arxiv.org/abs/1910.10781) [cs.CL]. URL: <https://arxiv.org/abs/1910.10781>.
- Yang, Zhilin et al. (2020). *XLNet: Generalized Autoregressive Pretraining for Language Understanding*. arXiv: [1906.08237](https://arxiv.org/abs/1906.08237) [cs.CL]. URL: <https://arxiv.org/abs/1906.08237>.



THANK YOU